Planning Ahead for Mom: How Much Is Written Down, and How Much Is Still in Everyone's Head?

Thirteen quick questions about what your family has on paper. At the end: what's written down, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how much of your family's planning is written down. It doesn't measure Mom or her finances, and nothing here says what she may qualify for or that anything needs doing now.

1. Is there a dated note of how Mom is managing today: what she does on her own, and where someone lends a hand?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Have you heard from Mom, in her own words, what she'd want if she needed more help one day?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Is there a one-page summary of her finances in round numbers: what comes in, what she has, what she owes?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Have you written down what you've read or been told about Medicaid so far, and who said it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know which legal documents Mom has, where each is kept and the date on it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Have you agreed which family members take part in planning?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Is there a written list of the things your family has thought about doing to prepare?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. On that list, have you marked what you'd ask a professional about before anyone does anything?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Does everyone know what your family's own next piece of organizing is, and who has it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down what your family is simply keeping an eye on?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Has your family talked over which changes would make you pick this up again, and written them down?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Are your open questions written down, each with the kind of professional it belongs to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

13. Is there a date on your notes, and have you agreed when you'll look at them again?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what's on paper, not how Mom is doing or what she has. A low count means there are things still to talk over or write down, and there's time to take them one at a time. It doesn't say what should be done now, what can wait, or what any of it means for paying for care. Rules vary by state, nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice, and those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of your planning are on paper and which are still unclear. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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